



WHAT COMES AFTER GRADUATION?

Navigating the transition from university to work, purpose and a new chapter.



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Graduation is a celebration—but it is also a transition. After the photos, congratulations and final assignments, many graduates face a new question: **What next?** Finding work, choosing a career direction, managing expectations, and adjusting to life after university can feel exciting and overwhelming at the same time.

YOUR FIRST JOB DOES NOT HAVE TO DEFINE YOUR WHOLE CAREER.

The transition from student to working adult is a process. Your first opportunity can help you learn what you enjoy, what you are good at, and what skills you still want to develop.

02

THE TRANSITION IS A JOURNEY

University often provides a clear structure: semesters, assignments, examinations and graduation. The world after graduation can feel less predictable. There may be applications, interviews, internships, short-term work, entrepreneurship, further study, volunteering—or periods of uncertainty.

01

EXPECT UNCERTAINTY

Not knowing exactly what comes next does not mean you are behind. Many career paths develop gradually.

02

START WHERE YOU CAN

An internship, volunteer role, entry-level position, project or small business can provide experience and connections.

03

BUILD A PROFESSIONAL IDENTITY

Learn how to present your skills, education, experiences and interests through a clear CV, profile and professional communication.

04

KEEP LEARNING

Graduation marks the end of one stage of education, not the end of learning. Keep developing practical and technical skills.

“You do not need to have your entire future figured out on graduation day.”

03

5 PRACTICAL STEPS AFTER GRADUATION

Focus on what you can do now rather than trying to solve your whole future at once.

01

UPDATE YOUR CV

Keep your CV clear, accurate and tailored to the opportunity. Highlight relevant education, projects, volunteering, internships and skills.

02

CREATE A JOB SEARCH ROUTINE

Set realistic weekly goals: identify opportunities, submit quality applications, follow up and keep a record of where you applied.

03

NETWORK WITH PURPOSE

Talk to lecturers, alumni, professionals, friends, community organisations and people working in areas that interest you. Let people know what you are looking for.

04

GAIN EXPERIENCE

Where possible, seek internships, volunteering, short projects, attachments or entry-level roles that allow you to practise your skills.

05

PROTECT YOUR WELL-BEING

Job searching can be stressful. Keep routines that support rest, connection, healthy habits and time away from applications.

Remember: progress can be quiet. A useful contact, improved CV, new skill or completed application is still movement.

04

WHEN THE PRESSURE FEELS HEAVY

Graduates may feel pressure to find work quickly, support family, repay educational costs, compare themselves with classmates, or meet expectations about what life should look like after graduation. These pressures can affect confidence and well-being.

NOTICE THE COMPARISON	MAKE A REALISTIC PLAN
Your classmates may take different paths. Their timeline does not determine yours.	Break your goals into weekly actions rather than measuring yourself only by the final outcome.
ASK FOR SUPPORT	ALLOW ROOM TO ADJUST
Speak with trusted people, mentors, career advisers or qualified support services when you need guidance.	Your first plan may change. Adjusting direction can be part of building a career.

MY NEXT-CHAPTER CHECKLIST

■ Update my CV	■ Identify 3–5 opportunities	■ Contact someone in my field
■ Learn or improve one skill	■ Explore experience opportunities	■ Plan time for my well-being

05

YOUR NEXT CHAPTER IS STILL BEING WRITTEN

A closing message from Community of Care Initiative

Graduation is not the moment when every question must have an answer. It is a milestone that opens a new stage of learning, work, relationships, responsibility and discovery.

You may get your dream opportunity quickly. You may need to apply many times. You may discover that the career you imagined is not the one you want. You may start somewhere unexpected and build from there.

Give yourself permission to begin. Keep learning. Ask questions. Build relationships. Take opportunities seriously without believing that one opportunity determines your entire future.

***GRADUATION IS NOT THE END OF THE JOURNEY.
IT IS THE BEGINNING OF A NEW CHAPTER.***

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